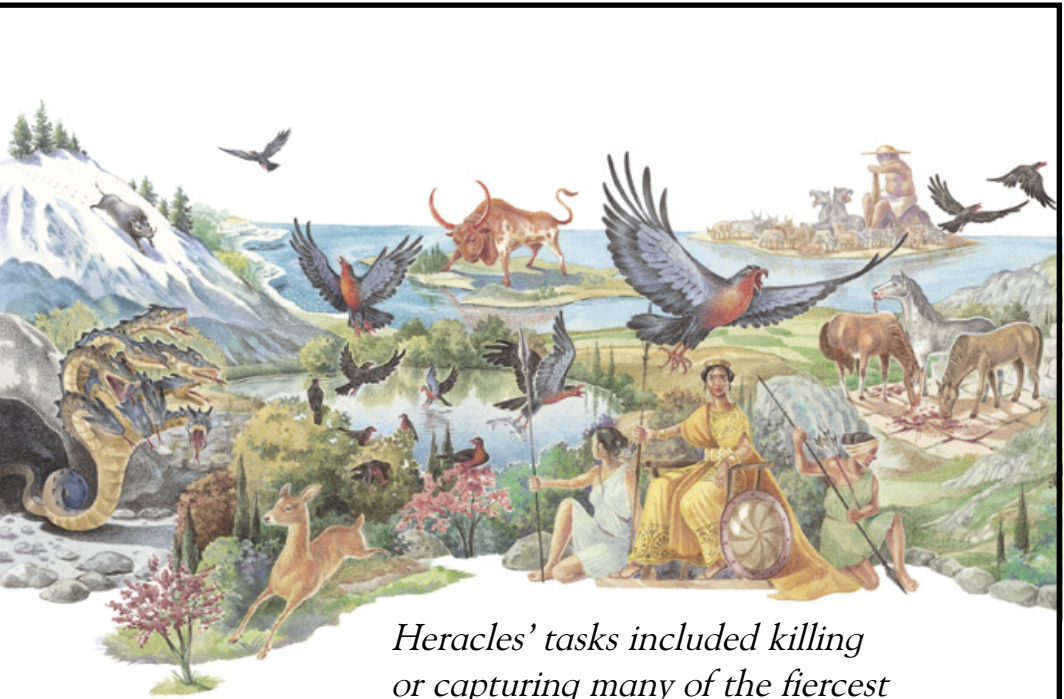




*Heracles' tasks included killing or capturing many of the fiercest mythical animals.*

After seeking advice from the gods, Heracles went first to the Hesperides' father, Atlas. He was one of the Titans defeated long ago by Zeus. Atlas's everlasting punishment was to hold up the heavens on his shoulders.

"If you ask your daughters for a couple of apples," said Heracles, "I'll hold up the heavens for a while."